

Robert Halvorsen

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Summary

Facilities and Operations Manager with over 22 years of experience overseeing industrial maintenance, plant operations, and facilities management for manufacturing and warehousing companies across Manitoba. Proven record of reducing downtime, leading cross-functional maintenance teams, and managing multi-site facilities budgets exceeding \$4M annually.

Professional Experience

Senior Facilities Operations Manager

Prairie Grain Processing Ltd., Winnipeg, MB — Apr 2014 to Present

- Direct facilities operations across 3 manufacturing plants totaling 480,000 square feet, overseeing a team of 28 maintenance and custodial staff.
- Reduced unplanned equipment downtime by 34% over four years by implementing a preventive maintenance scheduling system.
- Manage an annual facilities operating budget of \$4.2M, consistently delivering within 3% of forecast.
- Lead capital improvement projects including a \$1.8M HVAC system replacement across two plants.
- Oversee vendor contracts for janitorial, HVAC, electrical, and grounds services, renegotiating agreements that saved \$210,000 annually.
- Chair the site Joint Health and Safety Committee, reducing recordable incidents by 45% since 2016.

Plant Maintenance Manager

Red River Manufacturing Co., Winnipeg, MB — Jun 2008 to Mar 2014

- Supervised a maintenance department of 14 millwrights, electricians, and general maintenance technicians across a 220,000 square foot production facility.
- Implemented a computerized maintenance management system (CMMS) that cut work order backlog by 50% within the first year.
- Coordinated planned shutdowns for major equipment overhauls, completing all scheduled outages on time over a six-year span.
- Managed spare parts inventory valued at \$650,000, reducing carrying costs by 18% through better forecasting.
- Trained and mentored 5 apprentice millwrights through the Manitoba apprenticeship program.

Maintenance Supervisor

- Supervised a team of 8 maintenance technicians responsible for refrigeration, electrical, and building systems at a 150,000 square foot cold storage warehouse.
- Led the transition to a preventive maintenance program for ammonia refrigeration systems, reducing emergency repair calls by 40%.
- Coordinated with contractors on facility expansion projects adding 40,000 square feet of storage capacity.
- Maintained full compliance with provincial refrigeration safety codes across all annual inspections.

Industrial Millwright

Manitoba Steel Fabricators, Brandon, MB — Aug 1998 to Aug 2003

- Performed installation, alignment, and repair of industrial production equipment including conveyors, presses, and hydraulic systems.
- Diagnosed and resolved mechanical failures on production lines, minimizing downtime during peak manufacturing periods.
- Assisted in the commissioning of two new production lines as part of a facility expansion.

Maintenance Technician

Westman Food Processing, Brandon, MB — Jul 1995 to Jul 1998

- Performed routine mechanical and electrical maintenance on food processing equipment in a unionized production environment.
- Responded to emergency breakdown calls across three production shifts.
- Assisted senior technicians with boiler system inspections and annual pressure vessel certifications.

Apprentice Millwright

Westman Food Processing, Brandon, MB — Sep 1992 to Jun 1995

- Completed a four-year millwright apprenticeship while working under journeyperson supervision on production line equipment.
- Rotated through mechanical, electrical, and welding assignments to build a broad maintenance skill set.

Volunteer Experience

Volunteer Facilities Coordinator

Brandon Community Curling Club, Brandon, MB — 2000 to 2008

- Coordinated seasonal maintenance of the ice plant and clubhouse facilities on a volunteer basis.
- Organized a small volunteer crew for annual facility upgrades and equipment servicing.

Education

Industrial Mechanic (Millwright) Certificate of Qualification

Red River College Polytechnic, Winnipeg, MB — 1995

Diploma in Industrial Maintenance Technology

Assiniboine Community College, Brandon, MB — 1993 to 1995

Certifications

Red Seal Industrial Mechanic (Millwright) - Interprovincial Standards Program, 1996

Certified Maintenance and Reliability Professional (CMRP) - SMRP, 2012

Refrigeration Operator Certificate - Province of Manitoba, 2005

Occupational Health and Safety Certificate - IHSA, 2010

Forklift Operator Certification - Manitoba Safety Council, 2015

Skills

Preventive maintenance planning, CMMS administration, industrial refrigeration systems, HVAC systems, hydraulic and pneumatic systems, capital budget management, vendor contract negotiation, occupational health and safety compliance, team leadership, apprenticeship training, root cause failure analysis, shutdown and turnaround planning, spare parts inventory management, blueprint and schematic reading, PLC-controlled equipment troubleshooting

Languages

English (native), French (conversational)